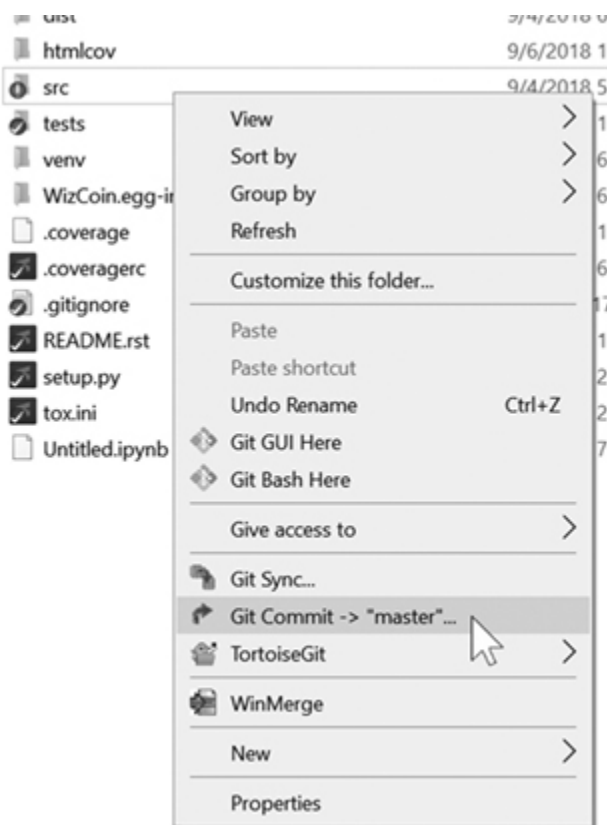


professional software developers who know the CLI Git commands often use GUI Git tools. The web page at <https://git-scm.com/downloads/guis> suggests several of these tools, such as TortoiseGit for Windows, GitHub Desktop for macOS, and GitExtensions for Linux.

For example, [Figure 12-3](#) shows how TortoiseGit on Windows adds overlays to File Explorer's icons based on their status: green for unmodified repo files, red for modified repo files (or folders containing modified files), and no icon for untracked files. Checking these overlays is certainly more convenient than constantly entering commands into a terminal for this information. TortoiseGit also adds a context menu for running Git commands, as shown in Figure 12-3.

Using GUI Git tools is convenient, but it's not a substitute for learning the command line commands featured in this chapter. Keep in mind that you might need to one day use Git on a computer that doesn't have these GUI tools installed.



[Figure 12-3](#): TortoiseGit for Windows adds a GUI to run Git commands from File Explorer.